

Universität St.Gallen

University of Economics, Law, Social Sciences, International Affairs
and Computer Science

How will the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland change by the end of 2025?

Seminar Paper

Introduction to Academic Writing

Author

Veit Norman Huber

[redacted]

[redacted]

25-612-987

veitnorman.huber@student.unisg.ch

[redacted]

Instructor

Daniel Riniker

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Abstract

This paper examines the expected development of the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland until the end of 2025. Using a linear regression model, four key influencing factors are analysed: the number of refugees, the male-to-female ratio, length of stay, and the general unemployment rate. On the basis of these variables, three scenarios are created: normal, optimistic, and pessimistic. The results show expected employment rates of around 41.5% in the normal scenario, 44.6% in the optimistic scenario, and 32.3% in the pessimistic scenario.

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1. Introduction

«We now need a jolt in Switzerland when it comes to integrating refugees into the labour market,» stressed Federal Councillor Beat Jans (Staatssekretariat für Wirtschaft [SECO], 2024), underlining the political urgency of promoting the employment of refugees.

Against this background, the Federal Council has set the goal of raising the employment rate of persons with protection status S[1] who have lived in Switzerland for more than 3 years to 50% by the end of 2025 (Der Schweizerische Bundesrat et al., 2025). This underlines the political significance. Ukrainian refugees in particular are the focus, since their arrival since 2022 has been considerable and directly affects the Swiss labour market. This gives rise to the central research question of this paper: How will the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland change by the end of 2025?

To answer the research question, four key factors influencing employment are analysed: the number of refugees, the gender ratio, the length of stay, and the general unemployment rate. The analysis is carried out using a linear regression model that quantifies the relationships between these factors and the employment rate. On this basis, three scenarios – normal, optimistic, and pessimistic – are developed in order to map possible developments until the end of 2025.

Earlier studies show that both individual factors such as language skills and level of education and structural framework conditions influence the labour market integration of refugees (Fasani, 2024, p. 23; Zürcher Hochschule für Angewandte Wissenschaften [ZHAW], 2024). For Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland, no quantitative forecasts of the employment rate are available to date. This paper analyses key influencing factors and derives scenarios for the end of 2025 from them.

This paper is structured as follows: Chapter 2 explains the methodological foundations, in particular linear regression. Chapter 3 describes the current labour market situation of Ukrainian refugees and the key influencing factors. Chapter 4 forecasts the employment rate under the three scenarios. Chapter 5 summarises the results, answers the research question, and gives an outlook on further research possibilities.

[1] Protection status S is a temporary protection that was introduced primarily for refugees from Ukraine. It allows access to the labour market but partly includes restricted access to integration programmes and social benefits. In exceptional cases, the status can also be granted to refugees from other countries of origin if a humanitarian emergency requires it. (Staatssekretariat für Migration [SEM], 2025)

2. Methodological Foundations

In this paper, a linear regression model is used to answer the research question. This chapter explains the methodological approach and the selection of the explanatory variables that influence the employment rate as the explained variable.

Linear regression models the relationship between the explanatory variables and the employment rate. On this basis, quantitative forecasts can be derived from qualitative assumptions (James et al., 2023, p. 69). It is thus a simple but meaningful instrument for estimating the possible path of the employment rate until the end of 2025.

The dependence of the target variable $Y_{Employment}$ (employment rate) on the key influencing factors $X_1, X_2, \dots, X_N$ is described by a multiple linear regression model:

$$Y_{Employment} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_1 + \beta_2 X_2 + \cdots + \beta_N X_N + \varepsilon,$$

where β_n represent the regression coefficients and ε the error term, which comprises all influences on the employment rate not explained by the selected influencing factors (Korkmaz, 2020, p. 407). In this paper, however, ε is not considered further, since the forecast is based on qualitative assumptions about the influencing factors. This is methodologically justifiable, since the forecast is deterministically based on scenarios and no statistical significance analysis is carried out.

The regression coefficients β_n indicate how strongly the respective influencing factors X_n affect the employment rate. The higher β_n, the stronger the factor acts on the dependent variable.

To estimate the coefficients, the method of «Ordinary Least Squares (OLS)» is used (Lakshmi et al., 2021, pp. 2017–2019). The β_n are chosen such that the sum of the squared deviations between the historical observations of the employment rate and the values predicted by the model is minimised.

For a forecast that is as reliable as possible, it is important that the selected influencing factors correlate strongly with the employment rate but only weakly with one another (Woolridge, 2016, p. 85). In this paper, no detailed correlation analysis is carried out. The variables are selected on substantive grounds, taking into account their broad independence. The specific influencing factors and the reasons for their selection are presented in Chapter 3.2.

Based on the methodology described in the previous chapter, the following chapter presents the current labour market situation and the key influencing factors of Ukrainian refugees. These variables then serve as explanatory variables for the forecast of the employment rate until the end of 2025.

3. Labour Market Situation and Influencing Factors

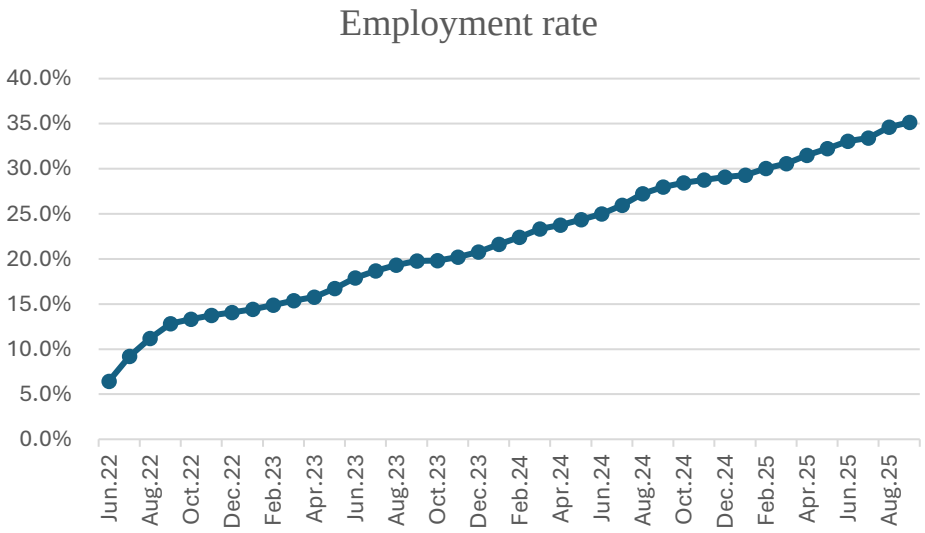
The following chapter analyses the labour market situation of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland. First, Section 3.1 outlines the current status quo on the basis of key figures and developments. Subsequently, Section 3.2 presents the main influencing factors that determine the employment rate and that are used for the forecast in the next chapter. This analysis thus lays the foundation for the quantitative modelling in Chapter 4.

3.1 Current Labour Market Situation

The labour market integration of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland has developed dynamically since the start of the refugee movements in 2022. By the end of August 2025, around 68,000 persons with protection status S were living in Switzerland, of whom about 98% came from Ukraine, which is why data that do not differentiate by nationality are also used in the linear regression analysis as representative of Ukrainian refugees (Eidgenössisches Justiz- und Polizeidepartment [EJPD] & Staatssekretariat für Migration [SEM], 2025). The employment rate of persons with protection status S stood at around 35% at the end of August 2025 and has risen since 2022, as Figure 1 shows (Ruedin, 2025, p. 26).

Figure 1

Development of the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland since June 2022



Note: Adapted from dataset *6-24: Bestand Personen mit vorübergehendem Schutz (Ausweis S) und Erwerb*, by Eidgenössisches Justiz- und Polizeidepartment [EJPD] & Staatssekretariat für Migration [SEM], 2025.

A key factor for the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees is the length of stay in Switzerland. Ukrainian refugees who have lived in the country for more than three years show significantly higher employment rates (Eidgenössisches Justiz- und Polizeidepartment [EJPD] &

Staatssekretariat für Migration [SEM], 2025), since their language skills (Fasani, 2024, p. 23) as well as their social networks continuously improve (Ruedin, 2025, p. 34). Those who have been present only for a short time, in contrast, have only limited access to the labour market, which is directly reflected in higher unemployment figures. This is due, on the one hand, to the still short length of stay and, on the other, to administrative restrictions such as the permit requirement, which make access to employment more difficult (Der Schweizerische Bundesrat et al., 2025). These are, however, to be lifted from December 2025 (Der Schweizerische Bundesrat et al., 2025).

The gender ratio also influences employment: Ukrainian men are on average about 6% more likely to be employed than women (Ruedin, 2025, p. 43). This difference affects the overall rate but is more homogeneous than in the Swiss population, where there are larger differences between men and women (Bundesamt für Statistik [BFS], 2025).

Further influencing factors are language skills (Fasani, 2024, p. 10), the industry structure (Ruedin, 2025, pp. 38–40), and the recognition of formal qualifications (Ruedin, 2025, p. 49). Despite high qualifications, many refugees work in areas in which they are underqualified (Ruedin, 2025, p. 48), in particular in the hospitality industry and in the IT sector (Ruedin, 2025, pp. 38–40), which at the same time show an above-average unemployment rate (Staatssekretariat für Wirtschaft [SECO], 2025).

Against the background of these differences, in particular the length of stay, the gender ratio, language skills, and the distribution across industries, an analysis of the key influencing factors is carried out in the next section. These factors serve as explanatory variables for the subsequent forecast of the employment rate until the end of 2025 and thus form the basis for the modelling in Chapter 4.

3.2 Key Factors Influencing the Employment Rate

For the forecast of the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees until the end of 2025, the key influencing factors that enter the linear regression model are presented below. These factors were selected on the basis of theoretical considerations, with a focus on variables that, on the one hand, are closely related to employment and, on the other, are largely independent of one another.

The relevant influencing factors include:

- number of Ukrainian refugees,
- male/female ratio,
- length of stay,
- as well as the general unemployment rate in Switzerland.

The variables show how personal characteristics and external conditions jointly influence labour market integration. Their significance for the forecast of the employment rate is explained below.

The number of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland influences the employment rate indirectly. A larger inflow raises the pressure on the labour market in the short term, especially in industries with limited capacity. At the same time, a larger foreign community can foster integration in the long term, e.g. through network effects (Bartig et al., 2025, p. 89). The variable thus acts ambivalently: burdensome in the short term, potentially integration-promoting in the long term.

As already shown in Chapter 3.1, Ukrainian men have a higher employment rate than women. This ratio is also reflected in the modelling: a rising share of women within the working-age population tends to lead to a lower average employment rate. The influence of this variable is mainly structural and acts directly on the forecast employment rate.

The length of stay in Switzerland is a key factor for the labour market integration of Ukrainian refugees. The longer a person has lived in the country, the higher the employment rate generally is, since language skills, social networks, and knowledge of the local labour market improve (cf. Ch. 3.1). Those who have been present only for a short time, in contrast, have only limited access to the labour market, which is directly reflected in higher unemployment figures, both because of the short length of stay and because of existing legal and administrative restrictions (Der Schweizerische Bundesrat et al., 2025). The variable thus significantly influences the forecast of the employment rate and forms an important component of the regression model.

The general unemployment rate in Switzerland forms the framework for the labour market integration of Ukrainian refugees. Changes in the Swiss labour market affect in particular the industries in which refugees are over-represented. For example, the unemployment rate in the hospitality industry is higher and fluctuates more strongly with the seasons than on average, while the IT sector is also affected by above-average rates (Staatssekretariat für Wirtschaft [SECO], 2025). These industry-specific differences are taken into account in the forecast, since they have a direct influence on the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees. The influencing factors presented form the basis for the subsequent scenario forecast of the employment rate until the end of 2025.

4. Assumptions & Forecast of the Employment Rate

This chapter forecasts the possible developments of the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees until the end of 2025. The basis for this are the four influencing factors identified in Chapter 3.2:

- number of Ukrainian refugees,
- male/female ratio,
- length of stay,
- as well as the general unemployment rate in Switzerland.

The analysis is based on data from the Federal Department of Justice and Police (EJPD) and the State Secretariat for Migration (SEM). The dependent variable is the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees, while the explanatory variables represent key integration factors such as level of education, language skills, and access to employment.

The assumptions are based on historical developments and reflect a qualitative assessment of possible scenarios. It is thus a model-based forecast that quantifies theoretically grounded relationships.

The forecast is made using a multiple linear regression model (cf. Ch. 2):

$$Y_{Employment} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_{No.\ Ukrainians} + \beta_2 X_{\frac{Male}{Female}} + \beta_3 X_{Length\ of\ stay} + \beta_4 X_{Unemployment\ rate}$$

The regression coefficients β_N show how strongly and in which direction the individual explanatory variables influence the employment rate. Table A1 in the appendix contains the complete estimation results. The error term is not taken into account in the forecast phase, since this is a model-based approximation on the basis of theoretical assumptions (cf. Ch. 2). A statistical error probability is therefore not reported.

Subsequently, three scenarios are distinguished – normal scenario, optimistic scenario, and pessimistic scenario. For each scenario, the assumptions about the influencing factors are defined, and the resulting employment rate is derived directly. The use of tables enables a compact overview and facilitates the comparison of the scenarios.

4.1 Normal Scenario

In the normal scenario, it is assumed that the framework conditions for the labour market integration of Ukrainian refugees will, until the end of 2025, largely continue in line with the development

so far. For the forecast, the influencing factors identified in Chapter 3.2 are taken into account with the following assumptions:

Table 1

Assumptions in the normal scenario

Influencing factor	Assumption	Effect on employment
Number of working-age Ukrainians	43’500	Stable continuation of the previous trend
Male/female ratio	58% men	Male share favours employment
Length of stay	Slightly rising	Longer stays lead to better integration
Unemployment rate Switzerland	3.45 %	Corresponds to the historical average; including hospitality and IT

On the basis of these assumptions, the normal scenario yields a forecast employment rate of approx. 41.5%. This scenario forms the reference for the comparative analysis of the optimistic and pessimistic scenarios and illustrates the expected development under stable framework conditions.

4.2 Optimistic Scenario

In the optimistic scenario, it is assumed that the framework conditions for the labour market integration of Ukrainian refugees improve slightly, which is attributable above all to a slight easing of the Russia-Ukraine war. The assumptions regarding the influencing factors are as follows:

Table 2

Assumptions in the optimistic scenario

Influencing factor	Assumption	Effect on employment
Number of working-age Ukrainians	40’000	Slightly lower number due to return of short-term residents
Male/female ratio	60% men	Higher male share increases employment
Length of stay	Moderately rising	Short-stay refugees stay behind → longer average length of stay
Unemployment rate Switzerland	3.3 %	Slightly falling due to stable economic situation

On the basis of these assumptions, the forecast employment rate is approx. 44.6%. This scenario shows how a moderate improvement in the framework conditions, in particular through an easing of the war, can have a positive influence on labour market integration.

4.3 Pessimistic Scenario

In the pessimistic scenario, it is assumed that the framework conditions for the labour market integration of Ukrainian refugees deteriorate, caused by a combination of an escalation of the Russia-Ukraine war and uncertain economic conditions. The assumptions regarding the influencing factors are as follows:

Table 3

Assumptions in the pessimistic scenario

Influencing factor	Assumption	Effect on employment
Number of working-age Ukrainians	46’000	Additional refugee movements increase inflow
Male/female ratio	50% men	Higher share of women among the inflow
Length of stay	Falling	New immigration lowers the average length of stay
Unemployment rate Switzerland	3.7 %	Rising due to economic uncertainty

Under these conditions, the forecast employment rate is approx. 32.3%. This scenario illustrates how an unfavourable geopolitical course makes labour market integration more difficult and can significantly reduce the employment of Ukrainian refugees.

4.4 Summary of the Forecast

The forecasts show that the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees develops differently by the end of 2025 depending on the scenario: under normal conditions it stands at around 41.5%, in the optimistic scenario at approx. 44.6%, and in the pessimistic scenario at about 32.3%. Key influencing factors are the number of refugees, the gender ratio, the length of stay, and the general unemployment rate in Switzerland; seasonal fluctuations and the industry-specific distribution are also taken into account.

The analysis is, however, subject to limitations: the model is based on aggregated data and simplified assumptions, dynamic effects are not captured, and individual influencing variables are subject to uncertainty. Despite these limitations, the forecast provides a plausible assessment of labour market integration until the end of 2025 and a basis for further investigations.

5. Conclusion

This paper examines how the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees in Switzerland could develop until the end of 2025. The starting point was the identification of key factors influencing employment: the number of refugees, the male/female ratio, the length of stay, and the general unemployment rate. On the basis of these factors, different scenarios were created to estimate future development under normal, optimistic, and pessimistic framework conditions.

The results show that the employment rate stands at about 41.5% under normal conditions. In an optimistic scenario it could rise to around 44.6%, while in a pessimistic scenario a decline to approximately 32.3% is to be expected. The forecasts make clear that the employment rate reacts sensitively to changes in population size, gender distribution, length of stay, and the general unemployment rate.

For further research, the analysis of political changes is particularly suitable. These include the effect of targeted integration programmes, the recognition of Ukrainian qualifications, or adjustments to the protection status, in order to increase forecast accuracy and to derive possible policy recommendations for political decision-makers. Overall, the paper provides an assessment of the employment rate of Ukrainian refugees until the end of 2025.

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List of Aids Used

Tool	Use
ChatGPT 4.0	**Proofreading:** • "Give me feedback on this paper. Take into account the requirements of this reader. Give me concrete, short bullet points." **Paraphrasing:** • "Rewrite the given text to a scientific standard." • "Shorten the given text without changing the content." • "Rewrite the given text to improve readability." • "I find the following text far too long and unnecessarily complicated for the reader. Rewrite it without losing the points." **Help with creating the tables:** • "How can I create a clear table in Word with the given data?"
Scribbr	The spell checker of Scribbr was used to prevent spelling and grammar errors. The citation generator of Scribbr was used to check the bibliography.
Endnote 21	For citations and the bibliography of those sources that were recognised.

Appendix

Below is the table that was used for the linear regression, the figure, and the tables:

Employment rate		Number of Ukrainians	Ratio	<= 6 Months=	12 Months=	18 Months=	24 Months	2 <= 3 years
Jun.22	6.4%	31’086	28.33%	31’086	0	0	0	0
Jul.22	9.2%	32’061	30.28%	32’061	0	0	0	0
Aug.22	11.2%	33’120	32.46%	33’120	0	0	0	0
Sept.22	12.8%	34’009	34.32%	17’038	18’257	0	0	0
Oct.22	13.3%	34’589	35.96%	10’973	24’895	0	0	0
Nov.22	13.8%	35’256	37.48%	9’032	27’513	0	0	0
Dec.22	14.1%	36’010	38.26%	8’385	28’912	0	0	0
Jan.23	14.4%	36’676	39.24%	7’923	29’966	0	0	0
Feb.23	14.9%	37’277	39.80%	7’350	30’667	0	0	0
Mar.23	15.4%	37’707	40.61%	6’923	15’672	16’460	0	0
Apr.23	15.8%	37’708	41.25%	5’895	10’490	22’670	0	0
May.23	16.7%	37’722	41.94%	5’128	8’514	25’407	0	0
Jun.23	17.9%	37’705	42.53%	4’426	7’973	26’586	0	0
Jul.23	18.7%	37’583	43.29%	4’214	7’222	27’322	0	0
Aug.23	19.3%	37’942	44.22%	4’218	6’537	27’804	0	0
Sept.23	19.8%	38’199	44.91%	4’187	5’977	14’313	15’008	0
Oct.23	19.8%	38’517	45.73%	4’293	5’176	9’552	20’781	0
Nov.23	20.2%	38’620	46.31%	4’206	4’624	7’740	23’320	0
Dec.23	20.8%	38’623	46.69%	3’783	4’138	7’259	24’681	0
Jan.24	21.6%	38’388	46.98%	2’909	4’187	6’638	25’795	0
Feb.24	22.4%	38’193	47.15%	2’115	4’220	6’036	26’447	0
Mar.24	23.3%	37’978	47.32%	1’346	4’264	5’534	13’282	14’834
Apr.24	23.8%	38’235	47.78%	1’088	4’390	4’839	9’028	20’170
May.24	24.4%	38’794	48.65%	1’504	4’210	4’332	7’247	22’777
Jun.24	25.0%	39’099	49.22%	1’665	3’901	3’901	6’859	24’042
Jul.24	26.0%	39’199	49.61%	1’825	3’385	3’910	6’268	25’064

Aug.24	27.2%	39’368	49.92%	1’934	2’874	3’895	5’642	26’257
Sept.24	28.0%	39’518	50.19%	2’059	2’436	3’901	5’219	27’110
Oct.24	28.5%	39’773	50.39%	2’116	2’093	4’026	4’554	28’175
Nov.24	28.8%	40’081	50.72%	2’155	2’093	3’887	4’089	29’030
Dec.24	29.1%	40’463	51.14%	2’205	2’068	3’667	3’677	29’983
Jan.25	29.3%	40’701	51.48%	2’084	2’173	3’290	3’680	30’534
Feb.25	30.0%	40’804	51.87%	1’945	2’269	2’927	3’658	30’603
Mar.25	30.6%	41’079	52.23%	1’776	2’446	2’537	3’717	17’557
Apr.25	31.5%	41’145	52.71%	1’537	2’569	2’219	3’845	12’905
May.25	32.3%	41’307	52.97%	1’346	2’615	2’229	3’737	10’761
Jun.25	33.1%	41’384	53.32%	1’163	2’634	2’180	3’538	10’032
Jul.25	33.4%	41’676	53.73%	1’222	2’433	2’325	3’197	9’525
Aug.25	34.6%	41’998	54.17%	1’423	2’200	2’425	2’848	8’875
Sept.25	35.2%	42’484	55.16%	1’862	1’960	2’539	2’479	8’503
Normal	**0.415092**	**43500**	**58.00%**	**1497.713**	**x**	**x**	**x**	**x**
Opti- mistic	**c 0.446303**	**40000**	**60.00%**	**1497.713**	**x**	**x**	**x**	**x**
Pessi-misti	**s 0.322921**	**46000**	**50.00%**	**3997.713**	**x**	**x**	**x**	**x**

> 3 years	ate > years	ate Switz.	ber of Ukrai- nians	Ra- tio	= 6 Mo- nths	> 3 years	ate > years	ate Switz.
0	0	2.00%	31’086	28.33%	31’086	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.00%	32’061	30.28%	32’061	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.00%	33’120	32.46%	33’120	0	0	2.00%
0	0	1.90%	34’009	34.32%	17’038	0	0	1.90%
0	0	1.90%	34’589	35.96%	10’973	0	0	1.90%
0	0	2.00%	35’256	37.48%	9’032	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.10%	36’010	38.26%	8’385	0	0	2.10%
0	0	2.20%	36’676	39.24%	7’923	0	0	2.20%
0	0	2.10%	37’277	39.80%	7’350	0	0	2.10%

0	0	2.00%	37’707	40.61%	6’923	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.00%	37’708	41.25%	5’895	0	0	2.00%
0	0	1.90%	37’722	41.94%	5’128	0	0	1.90%
0	0	1.90%	37’705	42.53%	4’426	0	0	1.90%
0	0	1.90%	37’583	43.29%	4’214	0	0	1.90%
0	0	2.00%	37’942	44.22%	4’218	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.00%	38’199	44.91%	4’187	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.00%	38’517	45.73%	4’293	0	0	2.00%
0	0	2.10%	38’620	46.31%	4’206	0	0	2.10%
0	0	2.30%	38’623	46.69%	3’783	0	0	2.30%
0	0	2.50%	38’388	46.98%	2’909	0	0	2.50%
0	0	2.40%	38’193	47.15%	2’115	0	0	2.40%
0	0	2.40%	37’978	47.32%	1’346	0	0	2.40%
0	0	2.30%	38’235	47.78%	1’088	0	0	2.30%
0	0	2.30%	38’794	48.65%	1’504	0	0	2.30%
0	0	2.30%	39’099	49.22%	1’665	0	0	2.30%
0	0	2.30%	39’199	49.61%	1’825	0	0	2.30%
0	0	2.40%	39’368	49.92%	1’934	0	0	2.40%
0	0	2.50%	39’518	50.19%	2’059	0	0	2.50%
0	0	2.50%	39’773	50.39%	2’116	0	0	2.50%
0	0	2.60%	40’081	50.72%	2’155	0	0	2.60%
0	0	2.80%	40’463	51.14%	2’205	0	0	2.80%
0	0	3.00%	40’701	51.48%	2’084	0	0	3.00%
0	0	2.90%	40’804	51.87%	1’945	0	0	2.90%
14’245	41.8%	2.90%	41’079	52.23%	1’776	14’245	41.8%	2.90%
19’267	42.3%	2.80%	41’145	52.71%	1’537	19’267	42.3%	2.80%
21’810	42.7%	2.70%	41’307	52.97%	1’346	21’810	42.7%	2.70%
23’021	43.3%	2.70%	41’384	53.32%	1’163	23’021	43.3%	2.70%
24’147	43.6%	2.70%	41’676	53.73%	1’222	24’147	43.6%	2.70%
25’388	44.7%	2.80%	41’998	54.17%	1’423	25’388	44.7%	2.80%
26’281	45.6%	2.80%	42’484	55.16%	1’862	26’281	45.6%	2.80%

31665.71	47.50%	0.03455						
31665.71	50.00%	0.0328						
31665.71	45.00%	0.0366						

Coefficients Intercept -0.22328

Number of employed Ukrainians -4.3E-06

Male/female ratio 1.157072

<= 6 months 1.26E-06

> 3 years 2.3E-06

Employment rate >3 years-0.06141

Unemployment rate 3.205874

Reflection on Own Contribution and Responsibility

1. Which parts of your work come entirely from you?

I developed the field of investigation, the research question, as well as the argumentation and structure of the paper myself. In addition, the research was carried out independently, as were the logical conclusions and the final assessment.

2. How did you check or revise AI-generated text suggestions?

Before incorporating outputs into the paper, I made sure that their content was correct and had the same meaning as the original text. Moreover, suggestions were only adopted if they offered linguistic or stylistic added value for the paper. The quality of the results was carefully checked to ensure that they matched the style of the paper.

3. At which points in the writing process was AI most helpful to you – and why?

AI was particularly helpful for formulating difficult sentences in a clear and simple way in order to improve understanding for readers. This was especially useful for me, since AI tools often suggest better formulations from which I can learn. In addition, the ability of AI to quickly proofread the entire text while maintaining a high degree of attention to detail is very valuable.

4. How did you ensure that no false or invented information was adopted?

AI was used exclusively to improve the language and clarity of the text and thus did not directly contribute to substantive statements or arguments. To ensure that the original statements did not lose meaning or become distorted through the revision, I carefully proofread all outputs in order to avoid false or ambiguous information.

5. What have you learned about academic writing through working with AI?

AI is an extremely useful tool, and a conscious approach to using it is very valuable. However, the quality and the added value that AI can offer depend strongly on the quality of the interaction with the tool and on making sure that it does not impair one's own critical thinking, the results, or the integrity of the work.

Declaration of Authorship

I hereby declare

- that I wrote this paper independently,
- that I wrote the paper using only the aids stated in the list of aids;
- that all parts of the paper produced with the aid of tools have been declared;
- that, when using AI, I handled both the input and the output responsibly.
  I confirm that I have thus only entered data that is public or released with consent, and that I have checked, declared, and traceably referenced all results and/or other forms of AI assistance in the required form, and I am aware that I bear the responsibility if, even unintentionally, erroneous content, violations of data protection law or copyright law, or academic misconduct (e.g. plagiarism) has occurred;
- that I have mentioned all sources used and cited them correctly in accordance with common academic citation rules;
- that I have acquired all intangible rights to any materials I may have used, such as images or graphics, or that these materials were created by myself;
- that the topic, the paper, or parts of it have not already been the subject of an assessment in another course or class, unless this was expressly agreed in advance with the lecturer and is stated in the paper;
- that I am aware of the legal provisions on the publication and disclosure of parts or the whole of the paper and that I comply with them accordingly;
- that I am aware that my paper can be electronically checked for plagiarism and for third-party authorship of human or technical origin, and that I hereby grant the University of St.Gallen, in accordance with the examination regulations, the copyright to the extent necessary for administrative actions;
- that I am aware that the University pursues any violation of this declaration of authorship and that disciplinary as well as criminal consequences may result from it,

which may lead to exclusion from the University or to the revocation of the degree.

By submitting the written paper, I declare that I have read and understood the declaration of authorship and submitted it truthfully.

St. Gallen, 25 October 2025

Huber, Veit

Signature:



Actual number of characters (including spaces): [19’305]